

1800-15

APRIL 1803

American negotiators agree to the Louisiana Purchase, a treaty to buy the vast Louisiana territory from France. Its slave or free status becomes controversial when it is settled by white Americans.

JANUARY 1808

Under the terms of the Constitution, the importation of slaves into the United States becomes illegal; the internal slave trade continues.

JUNE 1812

The United States declares war on Britain, beginning the War of 1812. Fighting continues into 1815.